

M A C C E S S I N C .

Private Security LA Worldwide | PPO #122729 | BSIS-Authorized Training Provider

BATON CERTIFICATION COURSE

BSIS Certified Training — Baton Permit Qualification

Authority: BPC §§7583.33 | 7585.9 | 7585.13 | 4-Hr Elective + 8-Hr Permit Course

MACCESS INC.

June 2026



IMPORTANT — READ BEFORE ADMINISTERING THIS COURSE

This 4-hour module is a BSIS elective course (BPC §7583.6(b)) that may be delivered by MACCESS INC. as a licensed PPO. However, the full 8-hour Baton Permit course and the issuance of a BSIS Baton Permit requires a BSIS-certified Baton Training Facility (TFB license) and a BSIS-certified Baton Instructor. MACCESS INC. must obtain TFB certification before issuing BSIS baton permits.

This 4-Hr Module Covers (PPO-Deliverable)

- Moral & legal aspects of baton use
- Use of force continuum — baton in context
- Baton types: side-handle, straight, expandable, ASP
- Target areas and prohibited strike zones
- Officer safety and baton handling fundamentals
- Carrying requirements, permit rules, recordkeeping
- Counts toward 32-hr BSIS elective credit

For Full BSIS Baton Permit Requires (TFB Only)

- 8 hours total instruction (BPC §7585.13)
- BSIS-certified Baton Training Facility (TFB license)
- BSIS-certified Baton Instructor on site
- Official 24-question BSIS written exam (pass ≥ 20/24)
- Correct identification of all vital body areas
- BSIS baton permit issued by certified instructor
- Roster submitted to BSIS within 5 working days

MODULE 1

Moral & Legal Aspects of Baton Use

Guard and employer responsibilities | Criminal, civil, and vicarious liability | BPC §7583.33 | PC §22001

California Law — Baton Carry Requirements

PC §22001 (formerly §12002): strictly limits who may lawfully carry a baton to specially trained individuals

BPC §7583.33: any security guard who carries a baton on duty **MUST** have: (1) a valid BSIS security guard registration, AND (2) a valid BSIS baton permit

Carrying without permit: criminal violation of PC §22001 — a felony charge

PPO liability: a PPO that allows a guard to carry a baton without a permit may be fined by BSIS

In-house/proprietary guards: also required to have both a guard card and baton permit (BPC §7585.14)

Baton permit expires every 2 years — renewal requires 8-hr refresher (recent BSIS update)

Moral Responsibility of Armed Security

The baton is a defensive tool — to protect yourself and others, NOT to punish or intimidate

Discretion: a guard must exercise restraint and judgment — the ability to use force does not mean it is appropriate

Public trust: guards who carry batons are held to a higher standard — misuse damages the entire profession

The baton is NOT an offensive weapon — using it offensively is a crime

Consider: is this the minimum force needed? Will force be proportionate to the threat?

Always attempt verbal de-escalation before drawing or using your baton

Criminal Liability

PC §242 — Battery: unlawful use of force on a person

PC §245 — Assault with a deadly weapon (baton can qualify)

PC §22001 — Carrying baton without permit: felony

Criminal prosecution is independent of civil suits

Excessive force: guard card suspension or revocation (BPC §7583.15)

BPC §7583.15: Director of DCA may immediately suspend a guard deemed a public safety hazard

Civil Liability

Excessive force tort: compensatory + punitive damages

Wrongful death: if baton use results in death

Intentional infliction of emotional distress

ADA violations: improper use against person with disability

Civil liability does not require criminal conviction

Documentation: failure to document use of force increases civil exposure

Vicarious Liability (PPO)

Respondeat superior: MACCESS INC. may be liable for guard's actions within scope of employment

Negligent hiring: failure to verify baton permit before assignment

Negligent training: failure to ensure proper baton training

BPC §7585.19: facility/instructor fines — \$100–\$1,000 per violation

PPO must report certain use-of-force incidents to BSIS per BPC §§7583.2 and 7574.37

MODULE 2

Use of Force

The force continuum | When the baton is justified | Avoidance | De-escalation | Deadly force | BPC §7583.7

Use of Force Continuum — Baton in Context

BPC §7583.7 | Objectively Reasonable Standard

1

PRESENCE & COMMUNICATION

Uniform, calm demeanor, verbal commands — always first

2

VERBAL DIRECTION

Clear, direct instructions: 'Stop. Step back. Leave the area.'

3

SOFT CONTROL

Guiding, escort techniques — compliant subject only

4

HARD CONTROL

Joint locks, control holds — actively resistant subject

5

⚠️ BATON — LESS LETHAL

Proportionate baton use — active aggression, imminent threat

6

🛑 DEADLY FORCE — LAST RESORT

Life or serious bodily injury imminent — only if no other option

When Baton Use IS Justified

- Active physical aggression toward you or another person
- Imminent threat of serious bodily injury — objectively reasonable belief
- Subject is armed with an object and threatening imminent attack
- Multiple subjects creating an elevated threat that verbal/soft control cannot address
- All justifications evaluated by the 'objectively reasonable officer' standard
- AFTER the threat stops: baton use must stop immediately

When Baton Use Is NOT Justified

- Passive resistance alone — refusal to move, sitting, etc.
- Verbal abuse or profanity — words alone do not justify force
- Property protection alone — baton cannot be used solely to protect property
- Trespassing without physical threat — call police; use verbal commands
- After the threat has ended — baton use post-submission is excessive
- Punishing or intimidating a subject after control is established

Avoidance, Escalation, and De-escalation of Force

AVOIDANCE: The best use-of-force outcome is avoiding force entirely — situational awareness, positioning, and early verbal intervention prevent most escalations

DE-ESCALATION: When a situation begins to escalate, your first tool is ALWAYS verbal de-escalation — speak calmly, use time and distance, call for backup, avoid cornering the subject

ESCALATION (when necessary): If de-escalation fails and a physical threat develops, escalate proportionately — do not jump to baton use without exhausting lower levels of the force continuum

DEADLY FORCE AND THE BATON: Strikes to the head, throat, spine, kidneys, and groin CAN cause death. Any strike to a vital area constitutes potential deadly force — only justified when you or another person faces imminent death or serious bodily injury

POST-FORCE: Once the subject is controlled, DE-ESCALATE immediately — no further force. Call for medical assistance if the subject is injured. Document everything.

DOCUMENTATION: Every use of the baton — even if contact is not made — must be documented in a written incident report within 1 hour. Notify your supervisor immediately.

MODULE 3

Baton Familiarization and Its Uses

Types of batons | Physical characteristics | Authorized types for California security guards | BSIS Baton Manual Ch. 3



Straight Baton

Classic single-grip straight baton. Solid or hollow construction. Standard lengths: 22"-26". Grip is at one end. Requires straight-baton ring carrier.



Straight Expandable (ASP)

Telescoping straight baton — collapses for carry, expands on deployment. Common models: ASP, Monadnock Auto-Lock. Requires holster or specific ring.



Side-Handle Baton

'T'-shaped baton with perpendicular handle. Allows blocking techniques not possible with straight baton. Requires side-handle ring. Common: PR-24®.



Side-Handle Expandable

Telescoping version of the side-handle baton. Combines side-handle blocking capability with compact expandable design.

Carrying Requirements

Guard must have VALID guard card on their person at all times while on duty

Guard must have VALID BSIS baton permit in possession while carrying on duty

Baton must be carried in an approved ring, holster, or carrier — never tucked in waistband

Off-duty: guards may NOT carry a baton — the permit is for on-duty carry only

A firearms permit does NOT authorize baton carry — separate permit required

Baton permit expires every 2 years — renewal = 8-hr refresher course before expiration

Permit Rules & Recordkeeping

Baton permits issued only by BSIS-certified Baton Training Facilities (TFB license)

Permit issued by the instructor, hand-delivered to student on completion

Roster must be submitted to BSIS within 5 working days of course completion (BPC §7585.14)

Lost permit: apply to BSIS directly with roster copy and \$25 fee (BPC §7585.16)

Expired permit: cannot be renewed — must apply for new initial permit

MACCESS INC. must verify each guard's permit before any baton-authorized assignment

MODULE 4

First Aid for Baton Injuries

Managing baton-related injuries in the field | When to call EMS | Documentation | BSIS Baton Manual Ch. 4

Immediate Response — Baton Injury

Call 911 immediately for ANY baton contact resulting in visible injury or loss of consciousness

Do NOT move an injured subject unless they are in immediate additional danger

Check for responsiveness: verbal, then gentle shoulder tap

Open airway: head-tilt/chin-lift — check for breathing

Control bleeding: apply direct pressure with clean cloth or gloves

Strikes to head, spine, throat: assume spinal injury — do not move, call 911 immediately

Blood-borne pathogen precaution: ALWAYS glove up before contact with blood

Documentation & Post-Incident Steps

Notify supervisor immediately after any baton contact — even if no visible injury

Complete written incident report within 1 hour — describe: threat, force used, target area, outcome

Note: did you call EMS? When? What was the subject's condition when EMS arrived?

Preserve the scene: do not alter or clean up until law enforcement clears the area

Cooperate with law enforcement — provide factual account, reference your written notes

BSIS reporting: PPO must report per BPC §7583.2 if injury occurred

Retain all records: BSIS may audit per BPC §7585.15

MODULE 5

Fundamentals of Baton Handling

Stances | Grips | Target zones | Prohibited areas | Defensive techniques | BSIS Baton Manual Ch. 5

Basic Stances

Interview stance: feet shoulder-width, weight balanced, non-confrontational — baton in ring, hands visible

Defensive stance: dominant foot back, weight shifted, baton accessible but not drawn

Active deployment: baton drawn, non-dominant side forward, baton in dominant hand

Positioning: stay outside of arm's reach — maintain reactionary gap of 6+ feet when possible

Never turn your back on an active threat

Back against wall or corner = poor tactical positioning — always maintain exit options

Grips & Drawing

Straight baton grip: dominant hand grasps handle firmly — thumb and fingers wrap fully

Side-handle grip: primary grip on main shaft, thumb on side handle for blocking

Expandable (ASP): firm flick of the wrist to deploy — check deployment before every shift

Draw: smooth, controlled — do not fumble or drop during draw

Retention: baton must stay in your control — do not allow subject to grab and disarm

Re-holstering: only after threat has fully resolved — keep eyes on subject

Target Zones & Vital Areas to AVOID

— VITAL AREAS — PROHIBITED STRIKE ZONES (unless facing imminent death or serious bodily injury)

- | | | |
|----------|-------------------------------|---|
| A | HEAD | Temple, skull, jaw — can cause brain injury, skull fracture, death |
| B | THROAT / NECK | Carotid, trachea — can cause asphyxiation, cardiac arrest, death |
| C | SPINE | Cervical, thoracic, lumbar — can cause permanent paralysis or death |
| D | KIDNEYS | Posterior lower back — organ rupture, internal bleeding, shock |
| E | GROIN | Can cause severe injury, nerve damage, shock |
| F | STERNUM / SOLAR PLEXUS | Can cause cardiac arrhythmia, respiratory arrest |
| G | KNEES (joints) | Can cause permanent structural damage, disability |

Authorized Target Areas & Defensive Techniques

Authorized Target Strike Areas

COMMON PERONEAL NERVE: outer thigh/knee area — effective motor-nerve strike, low injury risk

RADIAL NERVE: outer forearm — to disarm subject or break grip

INNER THIGH: effective for motor disruption — avoid groin area

UPPER ARMS: bicep/tricep area — motor disruption, lower injury risk

CALF / LOWER LEG: good target for subject who is fleeing or kicking

All strikes must remain proportionate to the threat — even authorized targets require justification

Defensive & Control Techniques

Blocking: use baton to deflect incoming strike — side-handle baton excels at forearm blocks

Control holds: baton as leverage tool to control a resisting subject after lawful arrest

Jabbing: front-thrust strike — useful for maintaining distance from advancing subject

Pushing: baton used to create space — not a strike, less force

Striking: only when blocking and control techniques have failed or threat escalated

ALL techniques must be demonstrated in in-person practical session (BPC §7585.9)

MODULE 6

On-Duty Conduct, Documentation & Recordkeeping

Baton on-post conduct | Incident reporting | BSIS records | Annual refresher | BPC §§7583.2 | 7585.15

On-Duty Standards for Baton-Carrying Guards

Never display or brandish the baton to intimidate — only draw when justified by threat level

Do not tap baton against palm, surfaces, or equipment as a warning gesture — this is intimidation

Maintain the baton in serviceable condition — inspect before every shift (expandable: test deployment)

Never loan your baton to another guard — the permit is individual

Observe client site baton policies in post orders — some sites prohibit visible baton carry

Maintain professional demeanor at all times — the baton does not change your authority or your limits

Incident Reporting — Baton Use

Any deployment of the baton — even if no contact is made — must be reported in writing

Report content: date/time/location, nature of threat, level of force used, area of contact if any, outcome

Notify supervisor immediately — MACCESS INC. policy and BPC §7583.2 require prompt reporting

PPO must report to BSIS if injury occurred or if suspect was arrested (BPC §§7583.2, 7574.37)

Retain all incident reports at the post level — available to BSIS auditors on request

Falsifying a baton incident report: \$1,000 fine per violation (BPC §7585.19)

BSIS Written Examination — Structure

24 questions total — each question worth 1 point

Passing score: minimum 20/24 (83%) PLUS correct identification of all vital body areas

Both conditions must be met — passing the written alone is insufficient

Not an open-book examination

Must be administered by a BSIS-certified Baton Training Instructor

Re-test may be granted at instructor's discretion (failing score must be recorded)

Answer sheets retained by facility for 2 years (BPC §7585.15)

Vital Areas — What You Must Identify

A — Head (temple, skull, jaw)

B — Throat / Neck (carotid, trachea)

C — Spine (cervical, thoracic, lumbar)

D — Kidneys (posterior lower back)

E — Groin

F — Sternum / Solar Plexus

G — Knees (joint area)

Failure to correctly name ALL seven vital areas = automatic exam failure, regardless of written score



Course Complete

Baton Certification — BSIS Elective Module

Proceed to the written assessment. Pass = 20/24 + correct vital areas identification.
Full 8-hr Baton Permit course and permit issuance requires BSIS-certified TFB and instructor.